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Israel's Policy in South Lebanon

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strong-arm tactics quell the ferment. They might even increase it. The situation calls for political, not police measures.

"If the autonomy will indeed be a 'full autonomy,' it might achieve the desired effect. An autonomy of the kind the government is still committed to will, however, in future also be rejected by most Arabs. If the government does not change its attitude on this, a regime of oppression will remain our only option. There can be no doubt that such a regime will not only do us moral harm, but will in fact constitute a prelude to our abandonment of the territories.

"In the long run, it is not possible to rule people against their will. The British learned this lesson between 1945 and 1948. How is it that a government led by the very people who were at the head of the underground movements in those days has failed to draw the logical conclusions from its own experience?"

ISRAEL'S POLICY IN SOUTH LEBANON

The spring offensive by Israel's proxy in South Lebanon, Lebanese Major Saad Haddad, against the UNIFIL peace-keeping troops stationed in the south of Lebanon led to the cold-blooded murder of two Irish soldiers captured by Haddad's militia. The result was international outrage and new moves by the sponsors of the UN troops to increase the contingent's effectiveness. An article in the *Jerusalem Post* (May 2, 1980) by David Landau and Adnan Safadi questioned the wisdom of Israel's unconditional alliance with Major Haddad and warned of the dangerous consequences that might ensue to Israel itself.

"The demeaning spectacle of Prime Minister Menahem Begin earnestly explaining to foreign envoys the inexorable process of a Middle Eastern blood feud should make us all sit up with a start. Is this where the government's policy in South Lebanon is leading the

country? To justifying, if not condoning, cold-blooded murder by invoking the vicious customs of bygone times?

"A propos quaint local traditions, there is a Middle Eastern proverb that says, 'It's bad enough when you think others believe your lie; it's worse still when you believe it yourself.'

"The lie in this case is that Israel 'cannot control Major Saad Haddad, it can only seek to influence him.' Not only does the government baldly expect the world to believe it (including the countries whose UNIFIL battalions see for themselves that it is not true), but Begin, spoon-fed tendentious information by army officers who have long ago taken South Lebanon policymaking into their own hands, seems to believe it himself. And he seems intent on getting his public at home to believe it too.

"Worse still, Haddad, who knows better than anyone else that it is false, is beginning to believe it as well — and to act accordingly.

" 'Cannot control Haddad' is a misrepresentation because Israel certainly *can* control him, if it wants to. He is, after all, totally dependent on Israel for everything. But Israel seems to have committed itself to supporting him blindly — and he pays faint heed to Jerusalem's feeble efforts to 'influence him' towards restraint.

"True, there is no clear-cut, easily formulated alternative to the present policy of supporting a local strong-arm baron and cocking a snook at the world. But that cannot excuse us from the duty to look for alternatives, and first and foremost to confront squarely the pitfalls of the present policy.

"The palpable spuriousness of the cannot-control-Haddad claim should bring us to face up to some other home truths about this 'Southern Christian gentleman,' as Israel's ambassador in Dublin, Shlomo Argov, dubbed him in an interview on Irish radio.

"The behaviour of Haddad's militiamen in the immediate aftermath of Operation Litani¹ does not bear close examination. Pillage, wanton destruction – and worse – were the order of the day. Indeed, the IDF's [Israeli Defence Forces'] passivity in failing to prevent these outrages has never been fully explained.

"The present writers believe that the ongoing alliance with Haddad, the unhealthy situation of occupation-by-proxy in which the IDF still finds itself enmeshed in South Lebanon, the 'blood feuds,' the smuggling and the playing-at-proconsul by IDF officers – all this has a corrupting and corrosive effect on the morals of the army and hence of the nation.

"All the subterfuge, so shallow and transparent, that accompanies Israel's unnatural role in South Lebanon, is destroying its credibility. The recent violence between the Irish battalion and the Shia Muslims found Israel trapped in its own dissembling. In the past Israel had proclaimed that the Shias – who, incidentally, comprise the large *majority* of the population in the 'Christian enclaves' – had willingly thrown in their lot with the brave Major.

"Now Begin, echoing Haddad's own lame claims after the killings, assures the world that the Shias are a power in their own right, independent of Haddad – just as Haddad is independent of Israel.

"The result has been a new spate of ridicule and obloquy heaped on Israel by its longtime enemies, always looking for a chance to hit at this country, and by newly lost friends whose hostility was gratuitously incurred.

"What a sad paradox that Ireland, the only state on earth to have *established* diplomatic relations with Israel since 1973, should be in the forefront now of a

diplomatic assault against it.

"Haddad's role as a 'security asset,' as a buffer between the PLO and Israel's northern border, is often cited as a factor outweighing his more awkward and unsavoury properties. This argument cannot of course be dismissed, especially since his men do trade frequent fire with the PLO enemy, and do sometimes pay the price that the IDF would otherwise have to pay.

"But Misgav Am and other incursions, some of which were foiled by the IDF at the border, must cast doubt at least on Haddad's military effectiveness. Indeed, the recent brief introduction of IDF policing units across the border (embarrassingly soon withdrawn under international pressure) appeared to underscore those doubts.

"It is easy for Israelis to disparage the 'blue berets' and to point to the dozens of known terrorist positions that are allowed to exist within the UNIFIL area of operations. It is more difficult, however, to rebut the UNIFIL argument that, as far as the Force's mandate is concerned, there is no difference between the PLO 'armed elements' and Haddad's 'de facto forces' (as they are called in the UN jargon). UNIFIL's mandate was, and still is, to clear the area from the Litani to the Israeli border of all armed irregulars.

"The PLO says it need not clear out unless Haddad's militia are cleared out too, and replaced by Lebanese government forces. UNIFIL, for whatever reasons of expedience or convenience, in effect endorses that argument.

"One can contend that Haddad's militiamen are not irregulars but the authentic representatives of Lebanese sovereign might. The trouble is that UNIFIL does not see things that way – and if Israel doesn't like the way UNIFIL

¹ Operation Litani is the name Israel gave to its invasion and occupation of South Lebanon in March/April 1978 – *Ed.*

sees things, it only has itself to blame. For it was Israel, with its ill-conceived and disastrously executed Operation Litani, that summoned UNIFIL into existence....”

SADAT VIEWED FROM ISRAEL

Ehud Ya'ari, who is the head of the Middle East section of Israeli television, wrote an article analysing Egyptian President Anwar Sadat's methods of maintaining political control, and outlining the chief features of the Sadat regime. The article, entitled "Sadat's Pyramid of Power," was published in the *Jerusalem Quarterly*, No. 14 (Winter 1980), of which extensive excerpts follow.

"Muhammad Hassan al-Tuhami, one of the few close associates of Egyptian President Anwar Sadat, once told this author: 'The secret of true leadership is always to be two steps ahead of the others and to let them try to catch up with you.' Tuhami sees this as the guiding principle behind the leadership technique which found its fullest expression in the Egyptian peace initiative. Indeed, this is an accurate definition of President Sadat's method. His regime reflects the virtuosity of a single person who knows how to make exceptional use of the power in his hands. It bears all the signs of a one-man show: a president who rarely consults his assistants or shares decisions with them, and frequently makes surprising decisions on his own; a ruler untrammelled by strong pressure groups; and one who favours the use of shock therapy in complicated situations; and a personality combining the capriciousness of a prima donna with the solidity of an omniscient father figure. Sadat tends to regard events as an expression of his personal will power, seeing new developments as further proof of the capacity of a single leader to change reality.

"The unique structure of the Egyptian leadership is not merely a formal matter but a practical one as well. Sadat the man, more than Sadat the president, is the axis around which the entire apparatus of power revolves, the orchestra which is attuned to accompany the soloist. Sadat himself very rarely intervenes in the day-to-day affairs of these power apparatuses and devotes his shortened work hours mainly to issuing directives and to making public appearances. His unchallenged supremacy derives from the recognition of his status, and not from his personal involvement in administration. Quite the contrary, he takes care to keep a distance from the structure underneath him, and yet he does not lose sight nor hold of it. The entire system adapts itself with amazing rapidity to his innovations, and accepts whatever far-reaching changes he decrees.

"Sadat did not inherit this kind of leadership from his predecessor. With all his legendary charisma, Nasser never enjoyed such actual personal power. Sadat has changed the character of the place occupied by the central figure in the Egyptian regime, and this has been but one aspect of the overall transformation which has occurred in the Egyptian pyramid of power.

"Certain differences in character between Nasser and Sadat have certainly contributed to their different ways of functioning: Sadat by his very nature tends to make decisions by himself, sometimes after a period of solitary reflection and partial fasting. He does not require counsellors, but rather assistants: people to carry out, not make, his decisions. Nasser, in contrast, appears in his memoirs, which have been published in the past few years, as a person who found it difficult to make important decisions in moments of crisis. Although he was far more suspicious and cautious than Sadat, he was freer in revealing his hesitations to his colleagues, and soliciting